

HS 608: Modern Western Social Thought

Course Code	HS 608
Course Name	Modern Western Social Thought
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	M.A. and Ph.D. students in HSS
Intended for	Ph.D.
Distribution	Core/Compulsory Course for SHSS Ph.D.
Approval	10th Senate (Jun 2016)

Course Contents

- Unit I: **Emergence of Modern Society** [10 Lectures]
 - The Intellectual Break with Tradition The philosophic underpinnings The Scientific Revolution - The socio-political conditions: industrialization, urbanization; the birth of ideology the idea of progress (6 contact hours)
- Unit II: **Some Approaches to the Study of Modern Society** [10 Lectures]
 - Individual & Community; Church & State; State as Actor in World History (Hegel)
 - Critique of Political Economy (Marx)
 - The Protestant work ethic (Weber), Division of Labour (Durkheim)
 - Urban society (Simmel, Lewis Mumford, Lewis Wirth)
 - Civilization and its Discontents (Freud)
- Unit III: **Political Thought** [12 Lectures]
 - Principato civile (Machiavelli); Three Forms of the Modern European State (Minogue)
 - Primary Social Goods and the Problem of Distributive Justice (Rawls, Dworkin, Nozick); Communitarianism and the Philosophy of the Common Good (Sandel, Taylor)
 - Open Society (Popper, Bergson); Democracy and Citizenship (Habermas: Civic Republicanism); Representation in Politics (Voegelin)
 - The Quarrel between the Ancients and the Moderns (Strauss/Cropsey)
- Unit IV: **Modern Economic System** [10 Lectures]
 - Capitalism and the approaches to understand Modern Economic System
 - * Philosophical Foundations of Capitalism (Adam Smith)
 - * Critique of Capitalism and the origin of Modern Socialism (Marx and Engels)
 - * Capitalism and its Discontents
 - World System Theory (Immanuel Wallerstein)
 - Neoliberal Capitalism and Globalisation (Stiglitz/Bhagavati/Friedmann)

Suggested General Reading

1. Barzun, Jacques: From Dawn to Decadence, 500 Years of Western Cultural Life, New York (Harper Collins) 2000.
2. Bell, Daniel: The End of Ideology. On the Exhaustion of Political Ideas in the Fifties, With The Resumption of History in the New Century. Harvard University Press, 2000.
3. Davies, Norman: Europe: A History, New York, OUP, 1996
4. Germino, Dante: Machiavelli to Marx, Modern Western Political Thought, University of Chicago Press, 1979
5. Hayek, Friedrich: New Studies in Philosophy, Politics, Economics and the History of Ideas, London, Routledge and Kegan Paul, 1978.
6. Hughes, Stuart: Consciousness and Society, The Re-orientation of European Social Thought 1890-1930, London, Paladin, 1973.
7. Morris, Ian: The Measure of Civilization, How Social Development Decides the Fate of Nations, Princeton University Press, 2014.
8. Plamenatz, John: Man and Society: A Critical Examination of Some Important Social and Political Theories from Machiavelli to Marx, London, Longmans, 1963.
9. Sedlacek, Tomas: Economics of Good and Evil, The Quest for Economic Meaning from Gilgamesh to Wall Street, New York, OUP 2011
10. Smith, Preserved: The Origins of Modern Culture, vols. 1 & 2. (Revised Ed.) Crane Brinton. (Collier) New York 1962.
11. Solomon, Robert C. History and Human Nature. A Philosophical Review of European Philosophy and Culture, 1750-1850. (Harvester) Brighton 1980.
12. Strauss, Leo: Liberalism Ancient and Modern, Chicago, UCP, 1989.